PREZIDENT, IJOD VA IXTISOSLASHTIRILGAN MAKTABLARNI RIVOJLANTIRISH AGENTLIGI

CONSTITUTION FOR THE PRESIDENTIAL SCHOOLS OF UZBEKISTAN

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1.0 Philosophy

The Presidential Schools programme represents transformative education for the Republic of Uzbekistan and an investment in the future of the country through the development of its most promising youth. The aim of the programme is to develop leaders who are competitive in the world market, and can serve their country in the areas of science, economics, politics, technology and sustainability.

1.1 Vision

The vision of the Presidential Schools is to prepare the next generation of leaders to actively and positively contribute to the development of Uzbekistan by providing educational opportunities that encourage the nation's gifted and talented youth to realize their potential as creative, innovative participants in a dynamic global society.

1.2 Mission

The mission of the Presidential Schools (PS) is to enhance the educational experience for gifted students through a programme of academic excellence and holistic learning opportunities to develop the leadership potential of its graduates to contribute to the future of Uzbekistan.

1.3 Profile of a Presidential School graduate

The profile of a Presidential School graduate identifies the attributes of a student able to successfully meet the challenges of the programme's vision and mission. The attributes serve as a clear visualization of the ultimate goals of learning and teaching.

- Ethical citizen
    - I demonstrate my civic responsibility to the Republic of Uzbekistan and to the global community through my positive contributions to society and my ethical decision-making;

- Critical thinker
    - I use reliable and relevant evidence to develop understanding across a broad range of disciplines to design and implement solutions to complex problems;

- Responsible
    - I take responsibility for my own actions and the consequences that accompany them, and view risk as an opportunity to learn;

- Academically prepared
    - I demonstrate mastery of academic skills and diligently pursue self-improvement in my understanding through achievements in coursework, competitions and research;

- Leader
    - I lead others by setting direction and creating a shared vision, by showing empathy and the willingness to consider different perspectives;

- Global citizen
    - I understand and appreciate my own culture and personal histories, and have respect for others' perspectives, values and attitudes. I acknowledge my duty as a global citizen to advocate for the sustainable development and environmental stewardship of my country and the world;

- Collaborator
    - I understand and express ideas and information confidently and creatively and through a variety of modes of communication. I seek a diversity of perspectives and value individual contributions toward problem-solving;

- Balanced
    - I develop myself in mind, body and spirit and understand the importance of emotional balance to achieve my personal well-being and that of others.

1.4 Ethics and Responsibility

The Presidential Schools (PS) network envisions a vibrant learning community with a shared vision and mission in which all stakeholders contribute to building a healthy and respectful environment where rights are respected, and all members find support and encouragement. This vision is supported by a shared code of ethics about wellness, respect, transparency and fidelity that provides guidance in decision making and interactions between community members.

- **Wellness**

  Wellness of students and staff is the foundation of a healthy community, and is the primary consideration in all matters. All decisions and interactions of the Presidential Schools are to be measured against this statement. The Presidential Schools aligns its practices with the UN Convention of the Rights of the Child (1990), of which the Republic of Uzbekistan is a signatory. Among all rights, PS specifically acknowledges the right to equitable education, the right to academic, social and emotional development, the right to develop as an individual, the rights of the parents in supporting the child, and the right of a child to relax and play.

- **Respect**

  All members of the community are treated with respect. The Presidential Schools network does not tolerate any form of discrimination or behavior in which stakeholders are deprived of their right to respectful and dignified exchange.

- **Transparency**

  All operations and decisions made by agents and employees of the Presidential Schools are executed with policy guidance and the transparency necessary to ensure fair, legal and procedurally driven actions. This statement is reinforced through a Complaints and Appeals Policy with a clear procedure and remedies accessible to all stakeholders.

- **Fidelity**

  All stakeholders commit to understand, respect and work toward the shared vision and mission of the Presidential Schools, and in the best interests of the students who the community serves. Policies and practices are developed for the welfare and positive development of the students in the care of the school, and in pursuit of the aspirational goals of the Presidential Schools network.

2.0 Governance

The Presidential Schools are a dedicated network of 14 schools for gifted and talented students organized under the Agency for the Development of the Presidential, Creativity and Specialized Schools under the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan (the Agency), established by the Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 9, 2019 (PD No: 5815). The Agency is the governing body for the Presidential, Creativity and Specialized Schools and University groups. The Agency serves as the custodian of the schools' Constitution and is ultimately responsible for each member school's adherence to the policies set forth therein.

Each of the Agency Schools departments is supported by shared general operational resources, including finance, logistics, monitoring and legal. Resource support is coordinated between the school's internal leadership structure and the shared departments, with Agency oversight.

General Operations	School Divisions
Mass Media and Public Relations Department	Department of Creativity Schools
Operations Department for Finance and Economics	Department of Specialized Schools
Department of Financing and Planning	Department of Presidential Schools
Accounting Department	Department of Universities
Department for Management of the Fund Capital	
Advisor to the Director for Pastoral work and legislation about the State language	
Operations Department for the Coordination of the Activity of the Schools	
Department for Improving Methodological Support	
Department for the Selection and Training of Teachers	
Department for Spiritual, Moral Education and Youth support	
Department for the Selection of Talented Youth and Organization of Olympiads	
Department of Organizational Control and Work with Appeal	
Textbook Development and Coordination Department	
Human Resources Department	
Department of Information and Communication Technologies	
Department for Material and Technical Supply	
International Cooperation Department	
Legal Department	
Department of Monitoring	
Internal Audit Service	

2.1 Governance roles and responsibilities

Senior governance and leadership roles for the Presidential Schools are as follows:

- Head of Presidential, Creativity and Specialized Schools
    - This position functions as the Chairman of the Board, as the final policy authority, custodian of the Presidential Schools guiding statements, and as the named child protection officer for all schools within the network. This position reports to the Director of the Agency.

- Head of Presidential Schools
    - This position functions as the executive manager of the Presidential schools and is responsible for policy direction and implementation, and ensuring that all general operations departments function in service of the Presidential Schools. The Executive Director of each school reports to this position. This position reports directly to the Head of Presidential, Creativity and Specialized Schools.

The Agency sets governance, academic and organizational policy for all Presidential Schools, and assigns the responsibility of translating policy into practice to the Executive Director of each school. The Agency is responsible for the creation of the Presidential Schools long-term strategic plan, and guiding each school in the execution of this plan. The Executive Director is the Educational Leader of the school, and reports to the Head of the Presidential Schools and the Agency.

- Role of the Executive Director of the Presidential School
    - The Agency empowers each Executive Director to be the responsible authority for building a safe and healthy community, ensuring quality learning and teaching, and aligning the school's practices with the vision and mission of the Presidential Schools. Specifically, the responsibility of the Executive Director include putting systems in place for:

        - Ensuring the wellness of students and the health of the school community
        - Monitoring of the quality learning and teaching
        - Establishing strategic and operational plans that align the school with its guiding statements
        - Management of financial resources and infrastructure

2.2 Reporting

Each Presidential School Executive Director is responsible for preparing a report of the status of the school at the end of each term, and submitting this report to the Head of Presidential Schools. The report includes the status of each of the general areas of responsibility: wellness, academics, alignment with the mission of the school, and operational details. The term report serves as a measure of progress and monitoring throughout the year.

At the end of the academic year, the Executive Director prepares and submits a final yearly report with recommendations for the coming year. This report serves as a reflective piece about the health and performance of the school, and what the school sees as priorities for the next academic year. Each school's information contributes to the data from which the Agency creates the strategic plan for the Presidential Schools network.

The Head of Presidential Schools prepares an executive report to the Agency in its role as the governing board for accountability and strategic planning.

2.3 Finances

Social spheres, including education, are one of the priorities of the Republic of Uzbekistan. As written in the Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan, free general education is guaranteed by the State. The Presidential Schools are government schools, therefore costs are fully underwritten by the State budget.

Financial management for the schools is centralized as the responsibility of the Financial and Accounting departments of the Agency, and is legislatively driven. An annual budget is established for each school based on need and revision from previous years. Long-term financial planning falls under governmental development of the social and industrial infrastructure, and is planned for three-year cycles with annual revisions.

- Annual budgets for each school are based on the needs of the school and are approved by the Agency. The fiscal year is defined as January 1 to December 31. During the year, the Executive Directors of the schools may request budget adjustments based on need.
- School expenditures are fulfilled by the school accountant with the approval of the Executive Director.
- All school financial transactions must be processed through the school's accounting office, and cannot involve reimbursement.
- The Executive Director is responsible for the financial actions of the school.
- All expenditures are made from accounts opened in the Treasury of the Ministry of Finance through the software package "UzASBO", designed for complex automation of budget accounting and reporting.
- Schools submit financial reports to the Agency on a quarterly basis (four times a year). Reports are automatically generated through the UzASBO software package.

2.4 Human resources

Oversight for all hiring and human resources management is centralized to the Department of Presidential Schools in line with the labor laws of the Republic of Uzbekistan. International teacher searches are conducted centrally for all schools with the support of educator recruitment agencies. Selection of teachers is based on the needs of the Presidential Schools, and is conducted transparently. National teacher selection is conducted by the Executive Directors of the schools and approved by the Agency Department of School Operations.

Each school has a human resource manager responsible for staff contract management and personnel accountability. The human resource manager reports to the Executive Director, and produces on-demand reports of staffing allocation to the Agency.

National teachers are provided with contracts that are standardized to the Presidential Schools. Remuneration scales are set by the Agency, as are bonus tables for advanced degrees, Olympiad preparation, English language achievement and other incentives as listed in the national teacher salary publication.

International teachers are provided with teaching contracts that are standardized to the Presidential Schools. Salary is determined by a table set by the Department of Financial Operations. Pay and benefits are included in the contract provisions.

2.5 Strategic planning

Strategic planning for the Presidential Schools is conducted as a partnership between the Presidential Schools and the Agency. The Agency is responsible for the long-range strategic planning of the Presidential Schools, and ensuring that this vision is disseminated to the schools. Revision of the strategic plan is completed annually using information provided in each school's annual report..

Executive Directors are responsible for creating yearly school improvement plans that bring the schools closer to the vision and mission of the Presidential Schools network. School improvement plans are submitted to the Head of Presidential Schools and the Agency at the end of each academic year to ensure alignment with the long-range direction of the schools.

2.6 Community relations

The Presidential Schools model the transformational standards of excellence as envisioned in the Republic of Uzbekistan's national priorities. As such, each Presidential School and its community members are ambassadors of this program. Each Presidential School is expected to develop and maintain positive relationships with the community, including participation in local events, professional development support to regional teachers, and collaborations with local schools and community service agencies.

3.0 Guiding policy

All guiding policies are set by the Agency in its function as the governing body of the Presidential Schools. All Presidential Schools must adhere to these policies. It is the responsibility of the Executive Director to ensure these policies are shared and understood by all community members and reflected in practice.

3.1 Admissions policy

The Presidential Schools admits students according to results rankings from a series of monitored and independently assessed testing instruments.The Agency publicizes enrollment openings and assessment dates through local media channels. The Presidential Schools are non-discriminatory and welcome all age-eligible students to challenge the exams. Students who pass the first exam series are invited to a second assessment session. A final ranking of student results in Mathematics, English and Critical thinking is completed and submitted to the Agency. Successful candidates are offered placement to the Presidential School in order of rank. Students are considered accepted to the programme when parents agree to the written terms and conditions of enrollment.

3.2 Inclusion policy

The Presidential Schools programme acknowledges that all students have unique gifts, talents and abilities, and that all students admitted to the programme shall have equitable access to learning and support for learning in alignment with the Law of the Republic of Uzbekistan dated September 24, 2020, No. 637, “About education,” and other related RUz legislation. At the Presidential Schools, all people are respected regardless of their gender, race, age, religious beliefs, disability, ethnicity, social or economic background, geographic location and any other physical or emotional differences they may have. The Presidential Schools ethos mandates fair and equal treatment regardless of differences and maintains an inclusive environment. This is done by:

- Maintaining no tolerance for discriminatory practice
- Ensuring learning materials are non-discriminatory
- Ensuring school policies and procedures are fairly written and enforced
- Ensuring all school community members are treated fairly and equitably
- Ensuring all learners have equal access to opportunities and participation
- Responding to the diverse needs of learners
- Respecting the diversity of all members of the community

The Executive Directors assume the final responsibility for the schools’ application of the Inclusion Policy into practice.

3.3 Health and safety policy

Each Presidential School provides a safe and healthy workplace and learning environment for students, staff and visitors, and is compliant with all relevant health and safety legislation of the Republic of Uzbekistan. The Executive Director is responsible for ensuring that the school is compliant with all areas of health and safety, including facilities, medical services, nutrition services and conduct. All school community members are responsible for engaging in safe practices at the school, and reporting situations that may cause injury or illness. The Health and Safety Policy (Appendix A) for the Presidential Schools fully describes the school expectations, roles and responsibilities of each member of the community toward maintaining a safe and healthy environment.

3.4 Child safeguarding

The safety and well-being of students is paramount at the Presidential Schools. Each school is responsible for creating an environment in which students feel protected from physical, emotional or social harm, and understand their rights as individuals. All staff are responsible for the maintenance of a safe environment and for the protection of children from harm. The Executive Director is the designated Child Protection Officer for the school. The Head of Presidential, Creative and Specialized Schools as the Chairman of the Board is the designated final Child Protection Officer for the network of schools.

Care for the child at Presidential Schools moves well beyond safety into the proactive support of wellbeing. This is a critical issue as the schools are week-long residential facilities that provide pastoral care. Wellness support includes the provision of a school psychologist, class teachers, and evening teachers to monitor the wellbeing of the students and create a caring, family atmosphere of trust. Curriculum is balanced between academic and interest pursuits. All schools are required to produce schedules that promote academic support, personal development, social time and relaxation.

The Presidential Schools Child Safeguarding and Wellness Policy (Appendix B) fully describes the expectations, roles and responsibilities of each member of the community toward maintaining a safe and supportive environment, and the reporting mechanisms that ensure these expectations are consistently met.

3.5 Data protection

Presidential Schools regard personal information for all staff and students as privileged and have strict provisions to prevent the accidental or intentional sharing of this information. Staff personal information is maintained on a secure server. Physical copies of staff information are kept in the Human Resources office in securely locked storage.

Student data is kept on a secure server. Physical copies of academic records are maintained by the class teachers. All medical information is kept in a locked cabinet in the medical suite. The school psychologist maintains student records on a secure server and physically in a locked cabinet.

No staff member may disclose personal information about another staff member or student outside professional responsibility. This requirement and disciplinary action regarding a data breach are referenced in the Staff Code of Conduct (Appendix C).

3.6 Complaints and appeal

The Presidential Schools make decisions using policy guidance and always with the best interest of the student at the forefront of conversation. Presidential Schools ensure free exercise of the right to appeal and welcome any suggestions and concerns about their activities to continually monitor accountability and determine areas of improvement. The schools are committed to give prompt and serious attention to any appeal and achieve an effective resolution in a positive atmosphere. The Complaints and Appeals Policy (Appendix D) describes the mechanism and potential resolutions for complaints and appeals.

3.7 Review cycle

The Presidential Schools Constitution provides the framework for the operation of the Presidential Schools, and is designed to guide each school toward a common vision. The Constitution undergoes a three year formal review cycle to ensure that the policies contained therein continue to be relevant and support the mission of the schools. As a living document, it may be necessary to adopt, revise or

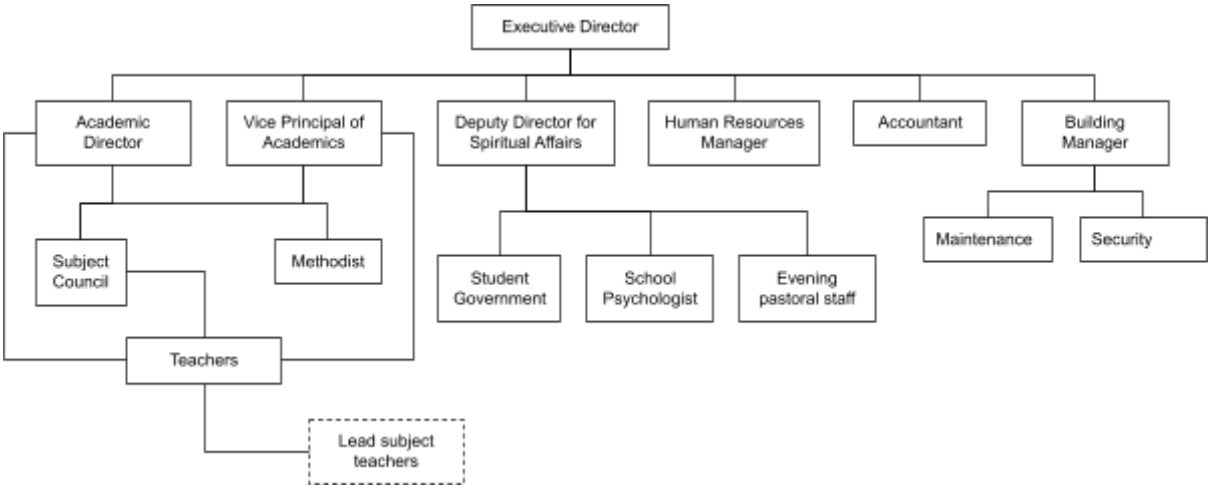
amend policy to reflect changing conditions. The ultimate authority for changes to the Constitution rests with the senior leadership of the Agency for the Presidential Educational Institutions.

The annual policy review takes place at the end of each academic year. The review is guided by reports submitted by each of the Executive Directors of the Presidential Schools, which include data regarding student achievement and welfare, facility operations and community relations. Changes to the policies named in the Constitution are introduced during the Agency senior leadership meetings and approved by consensus. Changes to the Constitution must align with the laws of the Republic of Uzbekistan and the Charter of Establishment of the Presidential Schools.

Changes to the Constitution as a result of the review process are distributed to all Executive Directors of the Presidential Schools for dissemination and implementation.

4.0 Organizational structure

The success of the Presidential Schools programme is built upon effective local leadership at each school site. Local administration works closely with the agency to execute plans and implement practices guided by policy.



4.1 Roles and responsibilities

The Executive Director provides leadership to the school community through oversight of academic, pastoral and operational departments. This position delegates responsibility for practices and plans to administrative team members who report progress to the Executive Director.

Academic

- **Academic Director**

  The Academic Director is responsible for the quality of instruction of international subjects, the fidelity of assessment, analyzing and reporting student results to the Agency monitoring department, and serving as a point of contact for international staff. This position is a yearly appointment and is evaluated by the Executive Director and the Head of Presidential Schools.

  The Vice Principal and Academic Director share responsibility for the observation and evaluation of teachers, identification of professional development needs, and ensuring that these needs are met. The explicit responsibilities for these positions are found in the respective Job Descriptions.

- **Vice principal**

  The Vice Principal for academics is responsible for the quality of instruction of national subjects, the coordination of Olympiad participation, custody of student academic records, organization of teacher seminars, and the formation of the Subject Council. The Vice Principal is the acting Head of School in the absence of the Executive Director, and is evaluated by the Executive Director.

- **Subject council**

  The Subject Council is responsible for hosting collaborative meetings between subject group teachers to plan events and activities, in class and outside class, to promote the subject groups. Each subject group is responsible for hosting promotional events throughout the year.

The Subject council produces the monthly calendar of events and provides this information to the Administrative team. The five departments comprise:

- Arts and humanities: Art, music, history, geography, citizenship *(ma'naviyat)*, global perspectives, character education (*tarbiya*)
- Sciences: General science, biology, chemistry, physics, physical education
- Mathematics and technology: Computer science, ICT, mathematics
- Languages: English, Uzbek literature and language, Russian (and *Karakalpak*)
- Tarbiyachilar (homeroom teachers): Evening activities

Subject council representatives are appointed by the Executive Director for one academic year and follow the specific responsibilities outlined in the Subject council leader Job Description.

- **Instructional Coach (Methodist)**

  The methodist position is responsible for observing classes and recommending professional development based on observations. This is an instructional coaching position to offer teachers pedagogical support. The methodist analyzes the quality of the lessons and of student learning. This position collaborates closely with the Vice principal, and is evaluated by the Vice principal with input from the Academic director. Specific responsibilities of this position are outlined in the Job Description.

- **Class Teacher**

  The class teacher is responsible for the administrative tasks associated with managing 12 students in an age/color group. The class teacher records group progress and reports on the academic and non-academic status of each student in the group. The class teacher maintains academic records for all students in the group, and is the principal contact between parents, students and school. Class teachers are appointed by the Executive Director based on their experience. Class teachers may not have teaching hours in excess of 20. The class teacher reports to the academic and pastoral administrative teams as appropriate. Specific responsibilities of this position are outlined in the Job Description.

- **Subject Teacher**

  The subject teacher is responsible for the conscientious planning of lessons, consistent high quality teaching, effective feedback from formative and summative assessment, and keeping accurate student learning records. Subject teachers prioritize the learning needs of students, follow schemes of work provided by lead teachers, and engage students in becoming academically skilled, competent, self-directed learners. Subject teachers report to the academic director and vice principal for school-based student issues, and report progress in subject learning to the lead subject teachers. Specific responsibilities of this position are outlined in the Job Description.

- **Lead Subject Teacher**

  The Lead subject teacher position is an Agency-wide assignment with responsibility to support academic achievement in a particular subject area. All subjects are assigned lead teachers. Lead teachers are responsible for producing year syllabi and schemes of work and submitting these documents to the Agency Monitoring Department for review and distribution to subject teachers. Lead teachers produce term tests and mock tests per the yearly assessment schedule. Lead teachers collaborate with subject teachers and academic administrators in each school, meeting according to the Agency's published schedule and additionally as necessary. Lead teachers communicate centrally with the Monitoring

department and the Agency. The Lead subject teacher is assessed at the end of the academic year by the Monitoring department and the Agency. Specific criteria for this position are listed in the Job Description.

Pastoral administration

- **Deputy Director for Spiritual Affairs**

  The Deputy director is responsible for the spiritual and pastoral well-being of students and staff. This position sets the expectations for a safe learning environment in which all community members feel secure and welcome. This position is evaluated by the Executive Director. Pastoral staff, including class teachers, evening teachers, building manager and the psychologist report to this position. Specific criteria for this position are listed in the Job Description.

- **School Psychologist**

  The School psychologist is responsible for the social and emotional support of the students. Responsibilities include student wellness campaigns and social/emotional coaching, and arranging group wellness activities. This position also counsels individual students and staff members upon request or recommendation and monitors specific cases upon referral. This position reports to and is assessed by the Deputy director. Specific criteria for this position are listed in the Job Description.

- **Evening Teachers**

  Evening teachers (*tarbiyachi*) are responsible for the pastoral life of students after the academic day of the students in their care. Evening teachers monitor the activities and wellness of students, and ensure that all students lead a balanced, healthy residential life. Evening teachers frequently offer tutorials and arrange activities for students. Specific criteria for this position are listed in the Job Description.

- **Student Government**

  Student voice is highly valued at Presidential Schools. Each school is responsible for assisting students in forming a representative government structure that connects students to the administration of the school in a meaningful way. Student government may take the form of a “house system,” a ministry structure or another representative form that ensures students have a real and contributing role in school life. The Deputy director shall ensure that the student government is formed, supported and respected by all school members.

Operational administration

Each Presidential School is supported by an operational section that includes an Accountant, a Human resources officer and the Building manager. The Accountant is responsible for maintaining accurate records of financial activity. The Human resources officer is responsible for the accuracy and completeness of documentation regarding staff hiring and qualifications. Both positions report to the Executive Director.

The Deputy Director for Spiritual Affairs is responsible for ensuring the health, safety, security and maintenance of the physical plant, medical and nutritional services, and follows the requirements set forth in the Health and Safety Policy. This position reports to the Executive Director and coordinates with the Building Manager. Specific criteria for operational positions are listed in the corresponding Job Descriptions.

5.0 Learning and teaching

The vision and mission of the Presidential Schools depends on the high quality learning and teaching that happens in each of the schools. This is a shared responsibility of every member of the community with a shared definition. The Presidential Schools policy defines high quality teaching and learning as “The collaborative effort between teacher and learner to build understanding through exposure to authentic experiences that provide learners the opportunity to strive toward their unique potentials.”

It is the responsibility of each school to put this definition into daily practice and ensure that all community members understand and act toward the spirit of this policy statement. Individual position responsibilities for supporting teaching learning are listed in respective Job Descriptions.

5.1 Curriculum

The Presidential Schools offer a blended curriculum of international program STEAM subjects and subjects aligned with the Uzbekistan national curriculum requirements. Students graduate from Presidential Schools with a Diploma awarded by the Ministry of Education and subject qualifications earned through achievement on external examinations administered by an international body.

Schemes of work are developed by subject lead teachers and distributed through a secure LMS to subject teachers. It is the responsibility of the Academic director and the Vice principal to ensure that teachers follow the submitted schemes of work and regularly measure student progress toward learning outcomes. It is a further administrative responsibility to ensure that technology, global citizenship and environmental stewardship are infused into the curriculum when practical, and when these topics enrich the learning. The academic curriculum and learning hours are determined by the Agency and distributed to each school to create student timetables.

- **Extracurricular activities**

  The Presidential Schools support the holistic development of students. Extracurricular activities play an important role in student self-initiative, broadening of experience and development of new talents and interests. Students choose activities based on need and interest, and are expected to engage in both academic and non-academic opportunities. Each school develops a suite of extracurricular activities tailored to the interests of its students, local community interactions and unique site-based resources. A students' survey will be administered before each term to identify their interests.

  Extracurricular activities are timetabled and published at the beginning of each term. This is the shared responsibility of the Academic director and the Vice principal. Students select and enroll in activities, and attendance is required. Evening teachers are responsible for ensuring that all students attend extracurricular activities, and report attendance to class teachers.

  All teachers are required to offer a minimum of two 60-minute extracurricular activities per week. Activities may be curriculum- or interest-related. Teachers who offer activities with low attendance will be asked to offer a more engaging activity.

  Quality assurance for the extracurricular programme is the shared responsibility of the Academic Director, the Vice Principal and the Deputy Director for Spiritual Affairs. Student survey data and informal observations are used to ensure that students are offered well-planned,engaging activities.

  The curriculum articulation, timings and content hours are listed in the Curriculum and Assessment Policy (Appendix E).

5.2 Global citizenship

The vision and mission of The Presidential Schools describes its students as “competitive in the world market” and able to “serve their country in the areas of science, economics, politics, technology and sustainability.” These aspirational goals can only be achieved through a thorough understanding of the national culture, the diverse perspectives of a connected global community, and the interconnectedness of humanity. The Presidential Schools policy defines global citizenship as “The acknowledgement of our shared responsibility as stewards of the Earth, as actors toward a sustainable future, and as persons respectful of our own cultural experiences and those of others.”

Each Presidential School carries the responsibility to integrate the spirit of global citizenship and interculturalism into the fabric of the school; through formal and informal instruction, through relationships between community members, and through explicit connections between the school, the local and global communities. The schools carry the further responsibility of determining how they will monitor and evaluate their global citizenship progress.

5.3 Assessment

Presidential Schools support the concepts of 'Assessment for Learning' and Assessment of Learning’. These concepts underline the belief that effective assessment provides information to improve teaching and learning, as well as providing ways to ascertain and develop the academic standards in each grade.

- **Formative assessment**

  Students are given regular feedback on their learning; so that they can better understand what it is that they need to focus on to develop their skills and knowledge more effectively. Through continuous assessment, teachers are able to adapt their teaching, using a detailed knowledge of each student (assessment for learning). Parents receive regular reports on their child's progress so that all stakeholders are able to work together to continuously develop the academic proficiency of all students.

  Assessments for learning vary in format and provide the student multiple ways to measure their understanding of a topic. Teachers share the results of formative assessments with students to encourage self-reflection about their learning.

- **Summative assessment**

  The Presidential Schools use a criteria and standards-based approach to student assessment. Criteria and standards-based assessment requires that criteria be identified and performance standards be described so that students know the level of performance required for each assessment task. It informs them what to aim for in their learning and on what basis their work will be judged. Summative assessment results are recorded in the grading system and represent the student’s academic achievement in each subject.

  Subject teachers are responsible for creating and administering assessments throughout each term. Lead subject teachers are responsible for creating common term tests to measure student progress toward defined learning objectives. The Monitoring department manages the administration of term tests and collection of results for analysis

Specific details of assessment expectations are listed in the Curriculum and Assessment Policy.

5.4 Academic integrity

The Presidential Schools approach academic integrity as a character value and encourage students to commit to academic honesty and show value for the individual work of others. Students are expected to complete their own work and respect the work of others.

Academic dishonesty includes plagiarism, copying, cheating on assessments resulting in unfair advantage, falsifying data or collusion, or breaching a secure area in which assessments are stored.

The Executive Director is responsible for receiving and investigating claims of academic misconduct. Specific procedures to follow for occasions of academic dishonesty are listed in the Student Handbook (Appendix F).

5.5 Language policy

The language policy for the Presidential Schools aligns with the law of the Republic of Uzbekistan “On education,” “On the state language” and other related legislation of RUz and applies to students, parents, faculty, staff and the entire community of Presidential Schools. The language policy recognizes Uzbek as the official language of Uzbekistan (and the inclusion of Karakalpak for the Republic of Karakalpakstan), promotes Uzbek language for all members of the community and develops its acquisition. In addition to the Uzbek language, English has been chosen as the language of instruction for STEAM subjects. Russian has been chosen as the third language for the Presidential Schools. Schools may elect to offer additional languages during extracurricular activities.

From grade 5, all STEAM subjects (Mathematics, Physics, Biology, Chemistry and Computer Science) are taught in English. Teachers of STEAM subjects shall use English language and shall be committed to provide a high standard of communicating, teaching and learning in English. Uzbek (or Karakalpak) shall be used for clarifications of understandings and scaffolding for English language learners. Non-STEAM subjects are taught in Uzbek (or Karakalpak). Each school is required to offer language acquisition support in mother tongue and English as required by individual students.

Competency in multiple languages is a central aim of the Presidential Schools in line with the profile of the graduate. To implement and develop the multilingual model, the Presidential Schools focus on active engagement by staff as well as students, with the following expectations:

- All non-English speaking administrators and staff members are provided with the opportunity to engage in English language acquisition learning during the working hours
- All non-Uzbek speaking staff are provided with the opportunity to engage in Uzbek language acquisition learning during the working hours

It is the shared responsibility of the Vice Principal and Academic Director to ensure that opportunities for staff language acquisition are provided during the work day, and that accurate records of language competency are maintained.

5.6 Teaching expectations

All staff are expected to maintain a consistently high standard of performance in the workplace in fulfillment of the vision and mission of the Presidential Schools. This includes:

- Completing all professional duties in a responsible, thorough and timely way
- Contributing to maintaining a safe and supportive environment that promotes mutual respect
- Being positive role models at school and in the community as program ambassadors
- Contributing to the family atmosphere of student nurturing at the Presidential School
- Accepting professional responsibility for providing high quality teaching
- Treating all students as individuals with unique personalities, learning and support needs
- Commit to pursuing professional learning.

Specific expectations for teachers, responsibilities, reporting, observation, evaluation, retention and professional development are policies outlined in the Teacher Handbook (Appendix G).

The Presidential Schools programme represents the national transformation of the educational system for the Republic of Uzbekistan and therefore enjoys a high public profile. It is expected that all staff members project a professional demeanor and presence as ambassadors of the programme. All staff accepting employment with the Presidential Schools must be aware of and comply with the Staff Code of Conduct.

5.7 Student expectations

Presidential School students strive toward the academic and character outcomes of the profile of a graduate. Students apply themselves to their academic responsibilities, develop resilience and strength of character as they learn to lead by example in the community. Presidential School students are expected to:

- Fulfill academic obligations conscientiously, on time and with integrity
- Be respectful citizens at the school and in the community
- Strive for excellence in academic, physical, spiritual and social situations

The Presidential Schools are committed to taking all reasonable steps to ensure that students have the opportunity to succeed in the school's environment. Expectations for student academic performance, social development, residential life, advancement and dismissal from the program are outlined in the Student Handbook.

5.8 Technology policy

Technology use at the Presidential Schools is to enhance learning and teaching within the school. All classrooms are outfitted with smart boards, and wifi provided through a secure network. All students are provided laptop computers. Appropriate use of technology includes digital work production, research and communication. Staff are encouraged to infuse technology into the instruction to augment and transform learning through access to the internet and the use of digital tools.

Inappropriate use of technology includes downloading or viewing content not fit for an academic environment and cyberbullying. Minor technology infractions are referred to the class teachers. Persistent or major infractions are referred to the Deputy director for Spiritual Affairs for further action.

Staff are responsible to use technology responsibly, incorporating digital resources to enrich instruction and supporting students with learning resources outside of the classroom. Staff are required to maintain a digital classroom page for student access. All staff are required to use basic ICT skills in support of their duties, including email, document and spreadsheet generation, presentations and digital classroom production. The Staff Code of Conduct applies to the digital as well as the physical environment.

The Academic Director and Vice principal are jointly responsible for ensuring that all staff are appropriately trained with technology to competently use basic skills in the course of their responsibilities, and infuse technology where appropriate and meaningful in teaching. The Deputy director is responsible for ensuring that all students receive annual training about cyber security, cyberbullying and appropriate use of technology.

The Deputy Director for Spiritual Affairs in cooperation with the Building Manager is responsible for maintaining a safe and secure digital environment. This includes ensuring the IT technician maintains a firewall to protect students from unwanted content, and ensuring that all staff and students understand appropriate internet behavior. Further, the IT technician is responsible for the maintenance

of the network and associated hardware, reporting issues to the Building manager for address as necessary. Maintenance includes the specialized IT laboratories, and extends to software installation and updates to support curricula.

All IT equipment remains the property of the Presidential Schools and should be returned to the school when staff or students depart. Staff and students using IT equipment are responsible for loss or damage and will be assessed replacement or repair costs as necessary.

5.9 Parent communications

The Presidential Schools welcome parent contact because this fosters mutual understanding and support, which has a positive impact on student performance and their attitudes toward learning.

- **Open doors day**

  Each Presidential School hosts an open orientation day to present programmes and answer questions about the upcoming academic school year. The date for orientation day is announced two weeks prior to the event and is communicated electronically to parents by class teachers.

  In addition, each Presidential School hosts special open days for Grade 5 newcomers and Grade 11 students. The Grade 5 orientation provides families the opportunity to learn about life at the Presidential School, the school rules and regulations, and how the school maintains frequent contact between the student and home. The Grade 11 orientation is held before the end of the Term 1, and provides information about university options, assessment requirements, and preparation for life after school graduation.

- **Parent conferences**

  At the end of Term 2 and Term 4 each Presidential School hosts parent conferences in which teachers and students present a summary of their learning and achievements to parents. These presentations are meant to give voice to the students to talk about their learning as a proactive means of assuming responsibility for themselves and their progress, and for teachers and parents to form support plans individualized to each student.

- **Other communication**

  Parents who wish to communicate with the school about other matters may contact the class teacher, who will refer the request to the appropriate parties for scheduling. Parents may call the school administrative offices if communication with the class teacher is not practical. Communication between home and school is conducted through Telegram, the medium of access for parents, and/or by formal letter or email, depending on the nature of the communication.